

send students in their direction. The financial aid director at John Hopkins University is alleged to have received \$60,000 in exchange for sending students needing loans to a lender called Student Loan Xpress. The financial aid director at Columbia University also allegedly had \$100,000 of stock in this same company. Guess where he directed students?

The New York attorney general led the investigation into the abusive practices. According to a May 7, 2007 article in the *New York Times*, the Education Secretary tried to defend the government by stating that she “lacked the legal authority to clamp down on the many abuses.” Lacking integrity, perhaps. Lacking authority? Now the federal government is saying it does not have authority? Give me a break.

It gets my ire up when I think of all the outrageous, abusive, and predatory practices that these big corporations and lending institutions get away with. It is not the small-time local banker on the corner, it is the largest banks and credit card companies in our nation pulling these stunts. They need to be stopped, and it is time to blow the lid off how they do their business. The inner workings of the entire consumer lending industry are one of the greatest travesties that this country has ever seen. The money that they are making off me and you and just about every single one of us who has a car loan, a student loan, a home mortgage loan, a credit card, or any kind of bank loan is a crime. In my opinion, their methods should be illegal. They get away with their transgressions because they are the ones pulling the puppet strings on the guys who control the laws.

The License to Steal Is Government Issued

The student loan lenders gave pay offs and gifts to financial aid directors at various colleges and universities. In return, the financial aid folks advised their students to use their loan services. One director allegedly owned a huge chunk of stock in the student loan company that he sent his students to. Talk about looking out for #1.

It gets worse. A Department of Education official was also discovered to hold a large amount of shares in the same student loan company, and somehow he just forgot to disclose this fact to his employer, the